stalks. Can we do the same for food grains like rice and wheat? It is not possible because the grains are small in size and also the quantity is very large. Farmers separate grains from their stalks by beating them hard. The grains are separated from their stalks. This is called **Threshing.**

Winnowing

Rice, wheat and other food grains are covered with husk which cannot be eaten by us. Husk is very light and gets easily blown away by a breeze or wind. The method used for removing husk from grain is called **winnowing.**



This is done by dropping the mixture slowly from a height in the presence of wind. Lighter solids i.e. husks will be carried by wind and will be collected in a separate heap while heavier solids i.e. grains will fall closer and form a separate heap.



Rice husk also called chaff is the hard coating or protective covering on a seed or grains. It protects the seed during the growing season. Husk can be used as building material, fertilizer, insulation material and fuel.

Handpicking

How do we separate a stone from `rice? If the stones are visible different from the grain, they can be easily picked and separated by hand. This is called **handpicking**. But if the stones look very similar to the rice grains it is difficult to separate.



Magnetic Separation

In a mixture containing iron, the magnetic property of iron can be used to separate it from non- magnetic substances by using a magnet. Substances that are attracted to a magnet are called magnetic substances. Separating solids using a magnet is called **magnetic separation.**



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